

Fundamental Rights, DPSPs & Their Interplay

Articles, reasonable restrictions, enforceability contrasts and FR - DPSP harmony.

Portion focus ~86% · Topic: polity-const

PYQ themes: FR articles · DPSP · Reasonable restrictions · Art 32 · Harmony doctrine

Why this portion (PYQ lens)

Portion chance ~86%. Dense yearly hits; parent polity-const ~85%.

Years appeared (synthesis): 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Why UPSC asks this

Article clusters and justiciability contrasts produce reliable marks.

Syllabus framing

Portion chance ~86%. Dense yearly hits; parent polity-const ~85%. This portion sits inside polity-const and centres on Fundamental Rights, DPSPs and interplay. Article clusters and justiciability contrasts produce reliable marks.

Recurring PYQ angles: FR articles, DPSP, Reasonable restrictions, Art 32, Harmony doctrine. Approximate appearance years in the 2016-2025 educational synthesis: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025. Use the chance percentage only to sequence study hours - it is not an official prediction.

Core map of Fundamental Rights, DPSPs and interplay

Part III: Enforceable Fundamental Rights. Equality 14 - 18: Equality before law, non-discrimination, titles.

Freedom Art 19: Freedoms with reasonable restrictions grounds. Arts 20 - 22: Conviction protections and liberty/detention contours.

Hold this core map as your elimination spine before memorising peripheral CA overlays.

Core concepts and definitions

Art 21: Life and personal liberty - expanded jurisprudence awareness. Arts 23 - 24: Against exploitation.

Arts 25 - 28: Freedom of religion with limits. Arts 29 - 30: Culture and minority education rights.

Institutions, processes and mechanisms

Art 32: Constitutional remedies; heart-and-soul lore. Citizens vs persons: Some rights only for citizens.

Part IV DPSP: Non-justiciable but fundamental in governance (Art 37). DPSP classes: Socialistic/Gandhian/liberal-intellectual memory aid.

India angle and applied examples

Art 44 UCC: DPSP status; frequent CA. FR - DPSP history: From conflict to harmonious construction.

Minerva Mills: Harmony; limited amending power themes. Emergency effects: Historical suspension issues.

Comparisons, linkages and discriminators

Reasonable restrictions: Art 19 never absolute. Writ toolkit link: Connects to judiciary portion.

Property history bait: Beware outdated absolute property options. Horizontal/vertical: Primarily State action focus.

FR clusters you must own

Part III rights are enforceable. Equality cluster Arts 14-18; freedoms under Art 19 with reasonable restrictions; Arts 20-22 on conviction protections and liberty/detention contours; Art 21 life and personal liberty (jurisprudentially expansive); Arts 23-24 against exploitation; Arts 25-28 religion with limits; Arts 29-30 cultural and minority education rights; Art 32 constitutional remedies. Some rights are citizens-only - a classic discriminator.

Part IV DPSPs are non-justiciable but fundamental in governance (Art 37). FR-DPSP history moved from conflict narratives toward harmonious construction (Minerva Mills themes). Art 19 is never absolute; property history is a frequent outdated-option trap.

India angle

Connect rights CA lightly to static article maps.

Question patterns and exam spine

Matching lists and multi-statement questions on Fundamental Rights, DPSPs and interplay.

Revision spine: Definitions -> table -> India -> traps for Fundamental Rights, DPSPs and interplay.

Eliminate anachronisms and category errors first, then test remaining options against table rows and must-remember triggers.

Trap watch-list (specific)

Avoid: DPSPs enforceable like FRs. Avoid: All FRs for non-citizens equally. Avoid: Art 19 unrestricted. Avoid: Ignoring restriction grounds.

FR clusters

Cluster | Articles

Equality -- 14 - 18

Freedom -- 19

Life/process -- 20 - 22

Exploitation -- 23 - 24

Religion -- 25 - 28

Remedies -- 32

Common traps

x DPSPs enforceable like FRs

x All FRs for non-citizens equally

x Art 19 unrestricted

x Ignoring restriction grounds

Must remember

- 14 - 18/19/21/32
- DPSP non-justiciable
- Citizens vs persons

- Minerva Mills
- Reasonable restrictions

Quick revision checklist

- [] Reproduce table
- [] 5 must-remembers
- [] 3 traps
- [] India anchor
- [] 10 MCQs

Educational prioritisation heuristic - not an official UPSC prediction. (c) UPSC IAS Study Hub original notes.